

than just being first, what truly stood out was the impact that medicine had.

Until then, Adalimumab was not available in India, despite being the world's highest-selling drug. When we introduced it, we witnessed its transformative effect first-hand-patients with rheumatoid arthritis who could barely walk found themselves completing marathons. We heard stories of mothers who had been unable to care for their families due to debilitating pain and immobility, who, after treatment, could resume normal lives.

Those moments fundamentally shifted our perspective. They gave deeper meaning to the idea of being patient centric. They prompted us to ask: how can we create more meaningful impact through the medicines we develop?

It is easy to make a statin - anyone can make the tenth or twentieth version of the same drug. While it may be affordable and accessible, it does not truly create a difference. But launching the first flu vaccine during the H1N1 outbreak, being the first Indian vaccine manufacturer to respond, or developing Saroglitazar for MASH - all of these were first-in-class innovations for unmet needs.

Even when we are not the very first, we are often among the early few to make essential therapies available in new disease areas. That has become a powerful motivator-not just for me, but for the entire organisation. It has reshaped our thinking: how to be more patient-centric, how to truly put the patient first. Because without that purpose, it is easy to end up chasing goals without direction. And over time, I believe we have gained real clarity on our purpose - and built a meaningful path around it.

Delving into your focus on novel therapies, beyond rare diseases, are there any other areas that your company is concentrating on?

We have several areas of focus within our novel therapies portfolio. One notable indication where we've completed recruitment for clinical trials is Primary Biliary Cholangitis (PBC), an orphan indication in the US. This programme represents our most advanced initiative in the US market. Additionally, we're developing an oral product for anaemia associated with Chronic Kidney Disease (CKD), which has already received approval in India and is being considered for global

expansion.

Expanding our efforts in the orphan disease space, we're exploring treatments for conditions such as amyotrophic lateral sclerosis (ALS) and potentially Parkinson's disease, contingent upon favourable data from our ALS programmes. Furthermore, we're targeting the Cryopyrin Associated Periodic Syndrome (CAPS) indication, another rare autoimmune disorder. With a pipeline comprising approximately 20 molecules, we currently have four to six programmes in clinical development. We have also launched Nulibry TM, a medicine to treat MoCD (Type A) in the U.S. and are working on CUTX-101 (ZyCuboTM) to treat Menkes Disease in paediatric patients. This is a part of our efforts to building a wide portfolio to address rare and orphan paediatric diseases.

Sentynl Therapeutics, our group company in the U.S. acquired Zokinvy® (Lonafarnib) for treatment of Hutchinson-Gilford Progeria Syndrome, adding to its portfolio of biopharmaceuticals for rare and ultra-rare diseases.

Notably, we're advancing an oral malaria molecule, ZY19489 that addresses both resistant and non-resistant forms of the disease, offering a single-dose treatment option in collaboration with Medicines for Malaria Venture (MMV). Currently, in phase three clinical trials, this malaria treatment underscores our commitment to addressing neglected and tropical diseases. Our overarching goal is to not only create value for our company but, more importantly, to make a meaningful impact on patients' lives based on the data and outcomes we achieve.

Given this internationalization push, how significant is the Indian market for Zydus Life Sciences?

India has always been, and continues to be, a cornerstone of our operations. It serves as our home market and holds immense strategic importance for us. The majority of our innovation efforts are initially directed towards addressing the needs of the Indian market. We are deeply committed to expanding beyond offering medicines in the traditional sense and are rapidly evolving to provide comprehensive healthcare solutions encompassing services, care, hospitals, diagnostics, and more.

Our focus extends beyond pharmaceuticals to include consumer health, medical

devices, and diagnostics, among others. Our aim is to play a comprehensive role in managing lifestyle chronic diseases, such as cancer, where we have the largest portfolio of breast cancer products in India. From early diagnosis and treatment to post-care support, as a leading oncology player in India, we strive to offer a seamless care to patients.

Our vision is to provide an end-to-end solution that addresses every aspect of a patient's journey, recognizing that both pre-treatment and post-treatment phases are equally critical. India remains our primary focus, reflecting our dedication to transforming healthcare delivery and improving patient outcomes.

With regard to your foray in MedTech, how important is that going to be as a diversification strategy for Zydus?

When we looked at our 10- to 15-year strategy, we realised that our role as an organisation needed to evolve. That's why we transitioned from being positioned purely as a pharmaceutical company to defining ourselves as a lifesciences organisation. In doing so, we identified certain areas - especially specific disease segments where we could contribute more meaningfully beyond pharmaceuticals.

This led us to shape a strategy that focuses on delivering more holistic value to patients. Whether it's medical devices, companion diagnostics, or early diagnostics, we are exploring every aspect that can enhance the continuum of care.

In medical devices specifically, we have chosen to focus on three key areas. First is interventional cardiology, where we've acquired a manufacturing footprint in India and partnered with a Brazilian company called Braille Biomédica. Braille is one of the few companies globally to offer a TAVR (Transcatheter Aortic Valve Replacement) product. Secondly, we have completed the acquisition of Amplitude Surgical, which is a leading global player headquartered in France for surgical technologies for lower limb orthopaedics.

Third is nephrology, where we already hold a strong position as one of the largest players in India. This diversification allows us to strengthen our offerings in disease areas where we can make a deeper impact on patient outcomes.